

cell C2, select the cells from C3 down to the last value you need (corresponding to the amount of values in column A and B), and then press [Ctrl] + [V] (paste). This will automatically copy the formula and paste it in all the cells in column C. Remember this for all formulas you need to repeat across multiple cells.

2.3.2 Common Formulas

Apart from learning how to use basic mathematical formulas, there are some very common formulas that you will find yourself using. First we'll help you take basic mathematical formulas further by introducing brackets.

Let's say your task is to add cell values of column A with column B and then multiply column C from the result, and you want to add the answers in column D. By using brackets, just as you would in maths, you can ensure that you always get $(A+B)*C$ and not $A+(B*C)$. The syntax is as follows: `"=(A1+B1)*C1"`.

Of course, basic maths rules apply here too, so multiplication and division are always done before addition and subtraction. This means that if you're multiplying A and B and then subtracting C, you can just use the simple formula `"=A1*B1-C1"`; however, we suggest you get used to using brackets to make sure you always get the right answers.

Once you've learnt how to use brackets, you can move on to formulas that involve a lot more than a few cells, say, for example, adding and totalling all the hundreds of values in a column. It's fine to use formulas such as `"=((A1+B1)-(D1-C1))*E1"` when working with a few cells, but how do you calculate the total of, say, 300 cells in a column?

The SUM formula comes in handy here. We'll illustrate with a few examples below.

- `=SUM(A1:A65536)` will find the total of all values in column A
- To find the sum of column A and subtract it from the sum of col-